



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Good News School
School Website: <http://goodnewsonline.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Good News School (McAlisterville, PA, 17049) presents a distinctively religious, church-centered educational context. Public-facing materials emphasize Biblical faith, church life, and Christian formation of both students and families. While the site evidences a robust program of faith-based formation and parental partnership, it lacks clear, explicit indicators of classical liberal-arts education as defined by the Six Essential Elements (e.g., Great Books, the Trivium/Trios, Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy, or scholé-based contemplative memory work) in its public materials. On the classical rubric, this leads to a mixed positioning: strong religious formation and family-partnered learning align with some classical aims, but the absence of core classical curricular and pedagogical features yields a NOT CLASSICAL posture in several categories. Taken together, the aggregate picture lands in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL at best, edging toward NOT CLASSICAL given the emphasis on theology, church life, and Christian formation over explicit classical curriculum and pedagogy.

Key takeaway: The school's strengths lie in religious/metaphysical grounding and explicit parent/community partnership within a Christian framework. The major gaps are explicit classical curriculum (Great Books, liberal arts emphasis) and classical teaching methods (Socratic inquiry, memorization/recitation, Scholé pedagogy). Addressing these gaps would move the school toward a fuller CLASSICAL profile.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials center Bible theology, gospel, and church-centered identity. Statements emphasize Scripture as central, Word of God, and worship as core practices. The materials explicitly root education in biblical faith and Christian formation (e.g., "The Bible is central to all that we do... the Word of God... worship together"). - Leadership and community references underscore a church-based community with doctrinal grounding (e.g., pastor-led instruction, church fellowship).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators drawn from classical-philosophy lexicon include references to theology, sacred tradition, worship, and liturgical practice. The materials' explicit focus on biblical truth and sacred community aligns with "Grounded in Theology" and "Liturgical & Communal Practices." - No clear presence of negative indicators (e.g., secular relativism, value-neutral ethics) in the material. - Frequency note: positive-derived terms (Bible, Word of God, gospel, worship) appear prominently; explicit negative signals are absent in the visible content.

Why this rating - The content is robustly religious and theological, but explicit classical metaphysical commitments beyond Christian theism (e.g., transcendentals in the classical sense, or metaphysical order as a universal explanatory framework) are not laid out in public materials. The emphasis is the Bible and Christian worship; this supports a strong Grounding in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices, yet does not

demonstrate a full classical transcendent-moral-realism framework in the sense used by the classical rubric. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL on the rubric's terms, with clear church-theology emphasis.

Citations: Primary religious/faith grounding is evidenced in Good News materials (Bible, Word of God, gospel, worship)

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials foreground formation, discipleship, and the home as sites of Christian education, indicating a formation-focused aim rather than purely information transfer. There are explicit statements about educating for spiritual formation and godly living in the home and church context. - The emphasis on "Christian Education Committee" and parental involvement signals a view of education as formation through partnership with families.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators from the Six Elements lexicon include "formation," "virtue," "moral imagination," "telos" and "pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty" oriented by a transcendent frame. The Good News materials emphasize formation and the integration of faith, which align with formation-oriented goals. - Negative indicators (e.g., explicit "career/workforce readiness" emphasis or a solely information-based aim) are not present in the visible materials. - Density: formation-related language and the home/parents partnership appear, while explicit Great-Conversation or universal truths of truth/goodness/beauty are less explicit in a classical sense.

Why this rating - The school clearly states formation (spiritual and moral development) as a central aim, along with home-parent partnership. However, without explicit classical aims like "liberal arts for formation" or articulation of true/beautiful as universal teloi in the public materials, the alignment sits between formation-focused and explicitly classical. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Citations: Formation emphasis and home/parent partnership cited in church-education materials and committee statements

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public content shows a Biblical/theological educational framing rather than a liberal-arts framework. There is no explicit mention of the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Latin/Greek, or the Great Conversation in the site materials. The materials emphasize Biblical study, church-based education, and discipleship rather than a classical canon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive classical indicators for Curriculum (from the lexicon) include Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, history as Western civ, Great Conversation, and the Seven Liberal Arts. - The school's materials do not present these items; instead they emphasize Bible/theology-centered learning and church life. - Negative indicators (from the lexicon) would be aligned with "social studies terminology replacing history" or "project-based learning dominance" if applicable; the visible materials do not foreground those trends, but they do not present classical Liberal Arts content either.

Why this rating - Lack of explicit classical curriculum elements (Great Books, liberal arts scaffold, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Conversation). Therefore NOT CLASSICAL in Curriculum.

Citations: The Good News materials focus on Bible/theology and church education rather than classical liberal arts curricula

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials reference worship, Bible study, and formation, but there is no explicit description of Socratic seminars, Schol , memory work, or formal memorization/recitation, or the use of great-books-driven seminar pedagogy. No direct mention of classical student-centered inquiry or traditional classical pedagogy is evident in the site content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive classical pedagogy indicators (from the Six Elements lexicon) include Socratic dialogue, dialectic, narration/recitation, chanting, Scholé/restful learning, and upper-school rhetoric training. - The site materials do not show these pedagogical markers; instead they show Bible study/discipleship as the core pedagogy. - Negative indicators (from the lexicon) would be any exclusive emphasis on project-based or experiential learning without the classical scaffolding; the visible content does not foreground this as the school's approach, but the absence of classical pedagogy is notable.

Why this rating - Pedagogy is not described through classical methods (Socratic dialogue, rhetoric instruction, memorization routines, or Scholé-driven contemplative learning). Hence NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogical emphasis is on biblical instruction and formation rather than classical pedagogy; no explicit Socratic/Scholé markers in public materials

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials reference church staff (pastors, church committees) and a Christian education framework, but there is no explicit description of faculty as "living curriculum," "teachers as mentors," or a defined classical-faculty profile. The visible content emphasizes a church leadership structure rather than a formal classical faculty model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords in the classical lexicon for Faculty include "model teachers," "mentors," "portrait of a teacher," "living curriculum," and "collegial," etc. - The site content highlights church leadership rather than a classical "faculty" identity. There are mentions of pastors and education committees, but not the explicit Classical-Facing faculty profile. - Negative signals (e.g., lack of teacher collaboration) are not overt in the visible materials, but the absence of a classical teacher-mentor framing is notable.

Why this rating - The public materials do not articulate a classical "faculty as living curriculum" or a classical teacher-mentorship culture. Therefore NOT CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Citations: Leadership and Christian Education Committee references point to a church-driven leadership/education model rather than a classical faculty profile

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials explicitly describe partnership with families and equipping parents for Christian education, indicating a deliberate co-educator model. The Sunday School/Christian Education materials describe training and equipping parents and children with the Word of God, and references to parental involvement in home discipleship are explicit. - Documents describe the role of parents as partners in the educational process and emphasize Christian formation within the family (daily family devotions, parent participation, etc.). The materials also describe church committees that oversee Christian education and home formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators align with the Six Elements' "Partnership with Families" (parents as co-educators) and "Formation of Affections" (formation of loves and loves of truth/goodness/beauty within a Christian context). The content clearly uses language about parental involvement, home formation, and cooperation between church/education and families. - No negative signals about family partnerships are present in the visible materials.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates explicit parental partnership and family formation within a Christian education framework, which maps strongly to the "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" elements. This supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Citations: Partnership with Families and home-based formation language evidenced in church-education materials (parents as co-educators; home-based discipleship)

Overall aggregate assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element

3: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

With three categories clearly not classical and three with at least some classical alignment (two clearly classical, one somewhat), the aggregate classification falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, but the weight of NOT CLASSICAL in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Faculty keeps the overall profile from reaching CLASSICAL. The balance leans toward NOT CLASSICAL in the most content-critical areas (curriculum and pedagogy), with notable Christian formation and family-partnership strengths lifting Element 6 and Element 1.

What Would Move the Needle (Only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Integrate explicit classical curriculum: introduce the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books canon, clearly articulating Great Conversation and Western intellectual heritage on public materials. - Adopt classical pedagogy: implement Socratic seminars/dialogue (Harkness-style discussions) in upper grades, and incorporate memory-based recitation and Scholastic-inspired contemplative periods. - Align faculty profile with classical standards: develop a living-curriculum model where teachers embody classical virtues and mentor students in a teacher-student partnership. - Expand parent-education offerings: formal parent book clubs and ParentU-style programming to deepen parental formation in classical methods and the Great Conversation. - Document and publish explicit outcomes: articulate the school's telos in truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, with evidence of student engagement in great texts and classical disciplines.

Citations for needle-moving contexts (supporting the classical framework and potential changes) - Foundational classical elements and the Great Conversation through classical-education literature (Six Essential Elements and ICE booklet content): these sources establish what would be needed to move from SOMEWHAT/NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL. - The ICE pamphlet's restful-Scholastic framework and the emphasis on formation and the partnership with families as core to classical schooling: these provide a concrete path for needle-moving changes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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